

Why do Pro-Ai People Not See The Negative Environmental Impacts?

Posted by u/nonbinary-redpanda • 0 points • 11 comments

I just read this and am confused of how people who are Pro-AI don't understand the impact. I understand that research might not be everyone's specialty, but still. It has been consistently known that AI has negative environmental impacts. I looked on r/DefendingAI and they seem to think that AI doesn't have heavy bad effects. Why? Are they not looking it up? Are they just asking AI? Because if they ask AI how can't they realize that it would lie to them?

Comments

u/-Trash--panda- • 1 points • 2026-01-19 09:10 UTC

Because the environment impact is constantly being overblown while everyone ignores the massive impact from other sources. Even based on your own site, training equal to 5 American cars lifetime emissions. US has 300 million vehicles registered. Training the models is nothing compared to all the gas wasted in the US by everyone having their own car. Like having public transport that wasn't shit would make up for tens of thousands of AI models being trained.

The prompts themselves also aren't that bad compared to other shit we do. Like watching Netflix, YouTube or other online streaming services which also wastes a ton of energy from both your local TV's usage and the data center usage. Eating meat in general is also going to be far worse than any amount of AI prompting anyone is going to do.

It would legitimately be better for the environment if people spent time lobbying their local governments to improve public transit compared to complaining about AI's energy usage online. Like where I live the bus system is so useless that it would take me 4x longer than driving (not counting the time to walk to the bus stop and wait) and is usually so sporadic depending on the destination that it is not an option.

Want to try and guilt people online still, try convincing them to eat less meat if they want to use AI. Probably would end up being a net benefit even if they just swapped beef for chicken burgers.

u/Unfair_Golf2363 • 1 points • 2026-01-19 02:31 UTC

Others have a SIGNIFICANTLY larger impact on the environment. FOCUS on the bigger impacts first. This type of talk is why people are starting to take Anti AI as a joke

u/Prickliestpearcactus • 3 points • 2026-01-19 01:31 UTC

They don't care. I made a comment on another post on this sub about how much water AI wastes... one response was "but so does corn."

CORN. Which feeds people and is a staple food, and something that is used in so many products.

u/ihatethiscountry76 • 1 points • 2026-01-19 00:33 UTC

do you think conservatives care about america, or getting what they want, short-term?

now look at AI bros

u/FlashyNeedleworker66 • 1 points • 2026-01-18 20:01 UTC

It's significant. New boom industries this popular are, it's got a couple billion users and needs tons of capital investment to be built up. That will slow, and very well might stop if/when the bubble bursts.

As for me, I run almost everything locally (haven't been able to replace Claude code yet, but I'm working on getting some rtx6000s to do that) and my house is fully on solar so I feel ok about my use.

If we weren't going backwards on renewables, we could have our cake and eat it too, but the dumbass in charge of my country wants us to run on 20th century fuel sources.

u/nightwatch_admin • 4 points • 2026-01-18 19:56 UTC

Some think the genai/super intelligence will solve all the environmental problems, and to reach that, you'll have to build better models, and those can only be created with more and more training. Which is a complete piece of utter nonsense, but it's where you are.

u/SwedishFindecanor • 1 points • 2026-01-18 20:58 UTC

Every addict is fond of their excuses for their addiction. It makes them justify their dependence. Don't forget the one about building nuclear energy, and the myth that nuclear would be renewable.

The truth about nuclear is that while it is better than fossil fuels for the environment (as long as nothing goes wrong and we ignore the aspect of having to store the waste), it is still much much worse than **actual** renewable energy such as wind, hydro or solar.

u/nightwatch_admin • 1 points • 2026-01-19 06:18 UTC

Nuclear is also a bit of an issue in times of war or natural disasters.

u/SwedishFindecanor • 2 points • 2026-01-19 13:10 UTC

Indeed. That point has often been mentioned in debates about nuclear power here in Europe, where many are feeling the threat from a large neighbour to the East. Also: terrorism.

u/CoffeeSubstantial851 • 11 points • 2026-01-18 19:54 UTC

They don't care about the environment. This is what YOU aren't getting, if they don't give a shit about mass CSAM generation on X why the fuck would they care about bambi?

u/Sonicrules9001 • 8 points • 2026-01-18 19:41 UTC

They are part of a cult and refuse to accept facts or reality that doesn't fit with their AI religion.